

BIBTEX bibliography style `chicago18ad.bst` for the Chicago author–date citation style

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This document describes a new BIBTEX bibliography style file to assist L^AT_EX users with the preparation of a bibliography in author–date style according to the *Chicago Manual of Style*, 18th edition (University of Chicago Press 2024).

The style file builds upon and updates previous Chicago-style `.bst` files to produce a bibliography more-or-less in 18th edition Chicago author–date style, such that:

- it works with `natbib` 8.31b to produce `\bibitem` entries in the form `\bibitem[Jones et~al(1990)Jones, Baker, and Smith]{key}...`
- the number of authors’ (or editors’) names listed in the bibliography is reduced to a maximum of six, or truncated to three ‘et al.’ if there are any more
- DOI is used as first choice of online source for all items: the style file outputs the DOI if both `doi` and `url` are in the database entry, or outputs the URL (plus access date, if given) if there is no `doi`
- book entries can contain editors, translators and illustrators in addition to/instead of authors
- `@article` entries can contain an editor in place of an author, for citing a special issue or special section of a journal
- place of publication (`address`) for book publishers is not output
- entry types `@magazine`, `@newspaper`, `@periodical`, `@online` and `@webpage` are recognised for compatibility with other bibliography styles

This document is a work in progress. As the style file itself evolves, this will eventually become a complete user guide with examples and discussion of the new features.

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Setting up to use the style file

While the style file is in development (hence not yet in CTAN or installed as part of any L^AT_EX distribution) it will need to be downloaded from my GitHub repository and placed in the same directory as the .tex document for which you would like to create the bibliography.

The `chicago18ad.bst` file is fully compatible with the `natbib`, `doi` and `hyperref` packages. I have found the preamble settings

```
\usepackage[sort]{natbib}
\bibpunct[, ]{({})}{;}{a}{}{,}

\usepackage{doi}
\usepackage{hyperref}
\renewcommand{\doitext}{https://doi.org/}
\urlstyle{same}
```

useful during development and testing.

New (non-standard) entry types

The @magazine, @newspaper and @periodical entry types

These are (currently) just synonyms for the `@article` entry type, recognised for compatibility with other bibliography styles that use them. They all have the same required fields as an `@article`, with the added option of `editor` instead of `author` for citing a special issue or a special section. The `journal` field is always used for the title of the publication. (With the current version of this bibliography style, the `@article` entry type suffices in the BibT_EX database, whatever type of periodical the article appears in.)

The `@periodical` synonym, although non-standard, might make a good entry type to use when an entire issue, or even a section, e.g. a special issue of a journal, is cited, precisely because this is *not* referring to an individual article:

```
@periodical{Goo99,
  editor = {Good, Thomas L.},
  title = {Non-Subject-Matter Outcomes of Schooling},
  note = {Special issue},
  journal = {Elementary School Journal},
  volume = 99,
  number = 5,
  year = 1999
}
```

The `title` here is that of the issue, not of an article. (The `@article` entry type would also work just as well for this purpose.)

The @online and @webpage entry types

These are (currently) just synonyms for the @misc entry type, recognised for compatibility with other bibliography styles that use them. Like @misc, they have no required fields; all have the added option of `editor` instead of `author` for citing an online item with an editor. The alias to @misc is made because that is how references to websites/apps/social media will likely have been stored in many BIBTEX databases. Hence there are no required fields, because some of those entries will have a lot of the information in a `note` or `howpublished` field—this is fine; best results may be obtained by also using `url` and, where applicable, `month` and `lastchecked` (or `urldate`).

Recalling that @online and @webpage are synonymous with @misc (so please do use whichever you prefer), the *Chicago Manual of Style Online* includes the following examples:

```
@misc{Chi15,
  author = {{Chicago Manual of Style}},
  title = {Is the world ready for singular they? {W}e thought so
back in 1993},
  howpublished = {Facebook},
  month = apr # "~17",
  url = {https://www.facebook.com/ChicagoManual/posts/10152906193679151},
  year = 2015
}

@misc{Wik23,
  author = {{Wikimedia Foundation}},
  title = {Wikipedia: Manual of Style},
  note = {Last modified December 19, at 21:54 (UTC)},
  url = {https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Wikipedia:Manual_of_Style},
  year = 2023
}

@misc{YalND,
  author = {{Yale University}},
  title = {About {Y}ale: {Y}ale Facts},
  lastchecked = mar # "~8, 2022",
  url = {https://www.yale.edu/about-yale/yale-facts}
}
```

New (non-standard) fields

The translator field

This is included so that @book and @inbook entries can contain a translator in addition to/instead of an author and/or editor, and @incollection entries can

contain a translator in addition to an author and an editor. For example:

```
@book{Liu21,  
  author = {Liu, Xinwu},  
  title = {The Wedding Party},  
  publisher = {Amazon Crossing},  
  translator = {Tiang, Jeremy},  
  year = 2021  
}
```

Or:

```
@book{AdBe99,  
  author = {Adorno, Theodor W. and Benjamin, Walter},  
  title = {The Complete Correspondence, 1928--1940},  
  publisher = {Harvard University Press},  
  translator = {Walker, Nicholas},  
  editor = {Lonitz, Henri},  
  year = 1999  
}
```

BIB_{TEX} will not complain that you *can't use both author and editor fields* in a `@book` entry (because with `chicago18ad.bst`, you *can*), but will instead issue a warning that you have done so, in case this was inadvertent.

In order to output “secondary” editors and translators (as in the above example), the `author` field in the database entry must be non-empty—so if such a book ever has an author that is not a person’s name, it should be formatted as `author = {{...}}` rather than using a `key`, because the latter is too far down BIB_{TEX}’s pecking order for selecting what to use as the label. It is worth considering at this point that `chicago18ad.bst` will always make the label for a book item from the contents of the `author` field if there is one; if there is no `author` it will next look for an `editor` and begin with that; if there is no `editor` either, it will look for a `translator`; if there is no `translator` it will then look for a `key`.

In this way, you can have a translator without an author, for example:

```
@book{Sil74,  
  translator = {Silverstein, Theodore},  
  title = {Sir {G}awain and the {G}reen {K}night},  
  publisher = {University of Chicago Press},  
  year = 1974  
}
```

There is a translation of the same story by J. R. R. Tolkien, in a volume edited by his son Christopher. It will be apparent from the above that a database entry for this book that includes both `translator = {Tolkien, J. R. R.}` and `editor = {Tolkien, Christopher}` will result in the item being labelled and sorted as “Tolkien, Christopher, ed.; Tolkien, J. R. R., trans.” The cover

and title page of the copy I have seen foreground the translation, however—so the judicious omission (or suppression) of the `editor` field will achieve the label “Tolkien, J. R. R., trans.”

```
@book{Tol121,  
  translator = {Tolkien, J. R. R.},  
  title = {{Sir Gawain and the Green Knight, \textup{with} Pearl  
  \textup{and} Sir Orfeo}},  
  xeditor = {Tolkien, Christopher},  
  publisher = {HarperCollins},  
  year = 2021  
}
```

There is more work still to be done to implement the translator functionality in fine detail, such as when the editor and translator are the same person.

The `illustrator` field

This optional field is included so that book entries can contain an `illustrator` in addition to/instead of a (secondary) editor and/or translator (for references where the illustrations represent a noteworthy contribution to the publication).

Citing references in the text

Below are the sample citations from the *Chicago Manual of Style Online*:

Book

(Binder and Kidder 2022, 117–18)
(Yu 2020, 45)

Chapter or other part of an edited book

(Doyle 2023, 64)
(Marks and Parkin 2023)

Translated book

(Liu 2021, 279)

Book consulted in an electronic format

(Borel 2023, 92)
(Kurland and Lerner 1987, chap. 10, doc. 19)
(Melville 1851, 627)
(Roy 2008, chap. 6)

Journal article

(Dittmar and Schemske 2023, 480)
(Hebert 1925, 310)
(Kwon 2022, 1842–43)
(Lindquist 2023, 230)
(Snyder et al. 2025, 9–10)

News or magazine article

(Blum 2023)
(Klein 2023)
(Mead 2023, 21)
(Pegoraro 2007)
(Michelle [Reno], December 15, 2023, comment on Blum 2023)

Book review

(Jacobs 2023)

Interview

(Buolamwini 2023)

Thesis or dissertation

(Blajer de la Garza 2019, 66–67)

Web page

(Google 2023)
(Wikimedia Foundation 2023)
(Yale University n.d.)

Social media content

(Chicago Manual of Style 2015)
(NASA Webb Telescope 2022)
(Michele Truty, April 17, 2015, 1:09 p.m., comment on Chicago Manual of Style 2015)

Video or podcast

(Cowan 2022, at 6:09–17)
(Oliver 2022)

This guide also contains some additional worked examples (Adorno and Benjamin 1999; Good 1999; Silverstein 1974; Tolkien 2021) not listed on the web page. More example entries can be found in the `chicagodemo.bib` demonstration database in my GitHub repository.

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